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**EGGERT'S
BILLBOARD**

Are Seals Headed Here?

By BILL EGGERT

WESTWARD HO the Giants and Eastward ho the Seals—we hope. And it's two will get you three it might happen all because of one of the strongest friendships in baseball.

As the New York Giants trek across the Rocky Mountains there's all sorts of conjecture where the San Francisco Seals will go. Some say the Giants will trade the Seals' franchise for the Minneapolis franchise — an even swap. Others report the Giants already have offered the Seals' parents, the Boston Red Sox, \$125,000 for the Pacific Coast franchise.

We'd like to see it happen this way. Bring the Seals, who are leading the PCC, to Indianapolis.

Joe Cronin, who runs the Red Sox for millionaire Tom Yawkey, is closer than Saturday is to Sunday with Indianapolis Indians President Ownie Bush. It's a rigid friendship—one that enabled Indianapolis to get Outfielder Ted Beard from the Seals for \$1,000. Beard eventually was sold to the White Sox for \$15,000, the Red Sox getting half of the sale price.

IT'S VERY doubtful Andy Cohen will return here next year as a manager whether Indianapolis works with the White Sox or becomes a subsidized outlet for another big league club.

Joe Gordon, who is managing the Seals, probably will be in the running as the Giants' manager next season succeeding Bill Rigney. Joe DiMaggio is being boomed, also, as the Seals' first big-league manager. The Jolter is a native of San Francisco.

The 1957 Seals are mostly former Louisville players, when the Red Sox ran the Colonels. Fellows like Second Baseman Ken Aspromonte, who is leading PCC hitters; Outfielders Marty Keough and Albie Pearson and Pitchers Leo Kiely and R. W. Smith. There's also bonus Catcher Haywood Sullivan; the veteran Harry Malmberg, who played once before for Indianapolis, and Outfielder Bill Renna.

FRANK E. McKINNEY, who has made darn few mistakes in politics, financing or baseball, is convinced now that top minor clubs can't survive without major league ownership. McKinney, chairman of the Indians' board of directors, also, is close to Cronin.

The Giants official decision to move to the Coast will open the gates for a vast realignment of all baseball. For years the game has been out of step with progress but now that it has plunged and now that Indianapolis has held on to its franchise better baseball than ever before looms for central Indiana fans.

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